

AARON K. CLARK

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cryptojones.dev ◇ github.com/CryptoJones

EDUCATION

Eastern University <i>Master's candidate, Applied Artificial Intelligence</i>	2026 – present <i>Radnor, Pennsylvania</i>
Rochester Institute of Technology <i>MicroMasters (edX), Cybersecurity</i>	2021 <i>Rochester, New York</i>
Kennesaw State University <i>Graduate Certificate, Computer Science Foundations</i>	2019 <i>Marietta, Georgia</i>
Colorado State University <i>Graduate Certificate, Information Technology Project Management</i>	2018 <i>Fort Collins, Colorado</i>
University of Maryland University College <i>Bachelor of Science, Computer and Information Science</i>	2016 <i>Adelphi, Maryland</i>
University of Maryland University College <i>Undergraduate Certificate, Unix System Administration</i>	2013 <i>Adelphi, Maryland</i>
Purdue University <i>Diploma, Entrepreneurship Bootcamp for Veterans with Disabilities</i>	2013 <i>West Lafayette, Indiana</i>
Defense Information School <i>Diploma, Basic Public Affairs Specialist (Writer)</i>	2004 <i>Fort Meade, Maryland</i>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Data privacy and the limits of informed consent in consumer data collection; large language models and retrieval-augmented generation; locally hosted inference as a privacy-preserving alternative to third-party AI services; applied machine learning; cybersecurity and security operations.

PUBLICATIONS

Adams, B., **Clark, A. K.**, & Craven, J. (2020). *It is Free and Always Will Be — Trading Personal Information and Privacy for the Convenience of Online Services*. Kindle edition. ASIN B083R3155F.

Adams, B., **Clark, A. K.**, & Craven, J. (2018). *It is Free and Always Will Be — Trading Personal Information and Privacy for the Convenience of Online Services*. arXiv preprint. doi:10.48550/arXiv.1804.08491

INVITED TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

“Introduction to the OWASP Top Ten.” OWASP Omaha, Omaha, Nebraska. May 2021.

“Peeking into .NET Applications using dotPeek.” DEFCON 402 (DC402), Omaha, Nebraska. July 2019.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Harvard University <i>Teaching Assistant, online computation course</i>	2022 <i>Remote</i>
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PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Ronin 48 <i>Principal Software Architect (contract); Graduate Machine Learning Intern (contract)</i>	March 2026 – present <i>Remote</i>
Black Hills Information Security / Active Countermeasures <i>Senior Developer</i>	March – November 2024 <i>Remote</i>
CrowdStrike <i>Senior Technical Support Engineer</i>	August 2022 – March 2024 <i>Remote</i>
CloudHesive <i>Cloud Operations Supervisor; Cloud Support Engineer II</i>	August 2021 – May 2022 <i>Remote</i>
Tmutla <i>Cybersecurity Consultant (self-employed)</i>	February – August 2021 <i>Remote</i>
Reinke Manufacturing Company <i>Senior Developer</i>	December 2015 – February 2021 <i>Deshler, Nebraska</i>

HONORS AND AWARDS

President's Grant, University of Maryland University College — 2012

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- OPFOR (Red Team) Team Lead, Cyber Shield — 2021
- Room Watcher, National Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition — 2021
- Professional Mentor, Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS) — 2021
- Professional Mentor, Operation Code — 2015–2019

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) · American Physical Society (APS) · Open Web Application Security Project (OWASP) · Military Cyber Professionals Association · DEFCON 402 (DC402) · Rochester Institute of Technology Security Club

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Amazon Web Services: Solutions Architect – Associate (2022) · Certified Cloud Practitioner (2021)

(ISC)²: Systems Security Certified Practitioner (2021)

Microsoft: Specialist, Programming in C# (2016) · MCSA, Windows Server 2008 (2012) · MCITP, Server Administrator on Windows Server 2008 (2012) · Microsoft Certified Professional (2010)

Cisco: Cisco Certified Network Associate (2001)

CompTIA: A+ (2001) · Network+ (2001)

JOURNALISM

Reported and written as a United States Marine Corps public affairs specialist; published by Marine Corps News.

- “Hagee retires, Conway appointed 34th commandant.” 14 November 2006.
- “Folklore! Tradition! Change?” 24 February 2006.
- “Marine company retires guidon at United States Naval Academy.” 15 January 2006.
- “Marine receives Silver Star medal for combat valor.” 28 October 2005.
- “Marine serves two-year hitch in Corps.” 23 June 2005.
- “House, Senate help Corps celebrate 229th.” 1 November 2004.

MILITARY SERVICE

United States Marine Corps — Public Affairs Specialist (Writer). Honorably discharged.